



HEDEBY

GERMANY

POST CARD

Today: Hedeby – barely a Hedeby left to stand in, just a green ring of earthworks where the ramparts ran. From here I'm turning south: nothing but Mediterranean weather for the rest of this trip.

A woodcarver at the reconstruction huts showed me how the old branch-runes worked – count the branches one way for the family, the other way for the letter. I copied his Key out for you before I forgot it.

Love,
Aunt Liv

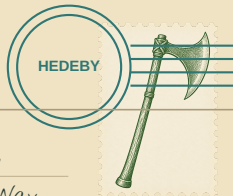
his Key, copied out:

1 – f u þ ö r k

2 – h n i a s

3 – t b m l r'

(left branches = which row. right = where in it.)



TO

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FUN FACT

In 1050, during his war with Denmark, Harald burned Hedeby to the ground — sailing burning ships straight into the harbour. Archaeologists later found their charred timbers still lying in the Schlei.